Whole-area representation: completing the Green Infrastructure Network on the Policies Map

Representation to the Swindon Local Plan 2043, Regulation 19 publication stage.

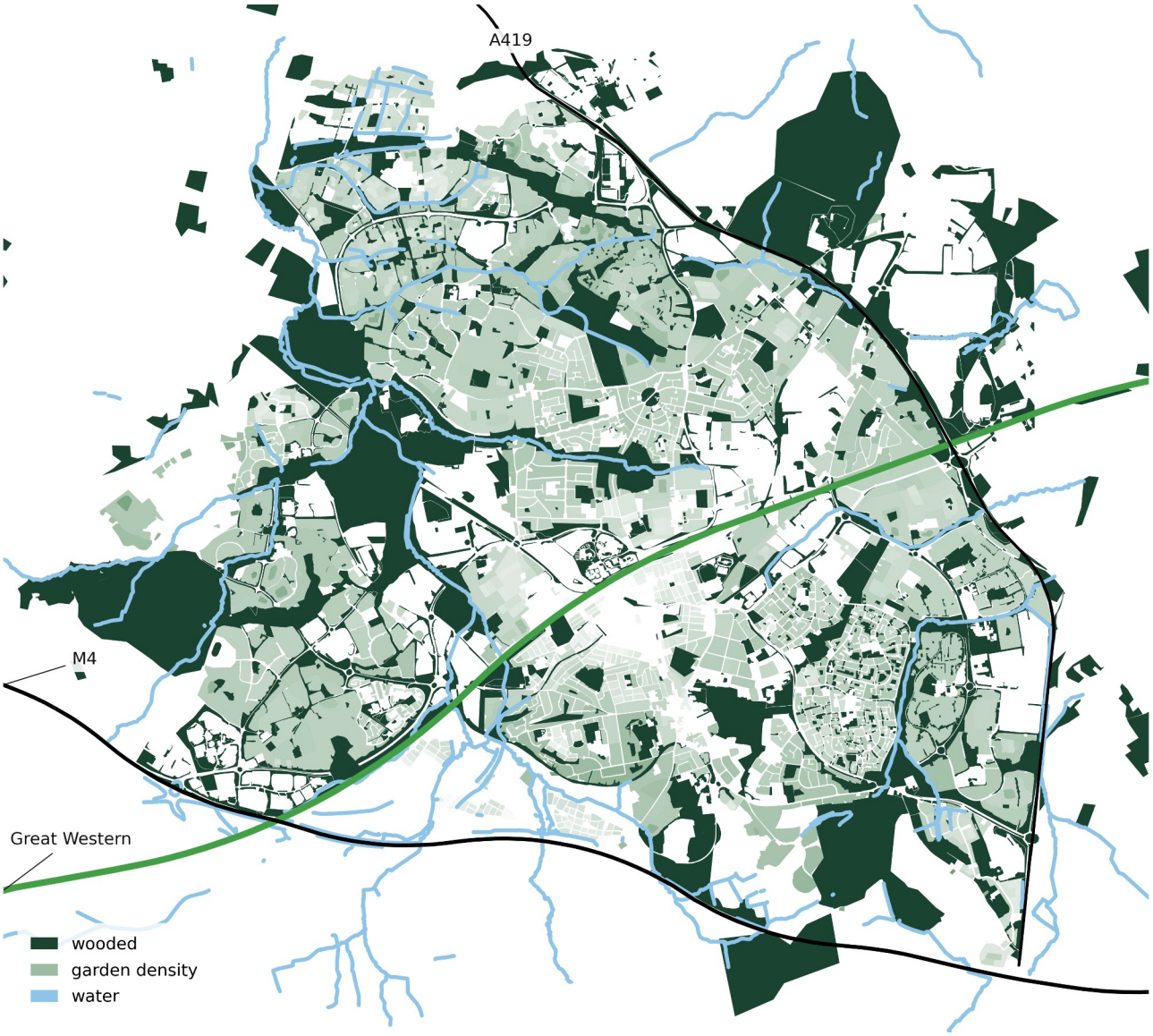


Figure 1. Current green spaces.

1. Representation by

[1.01] Name: Daniel Miller

[1.02] Organisation, if any: none - individual resident

[1.03] Address: withheld from this public copy (supplied to the Council)

[1.04] Email: withheld from this public copy (supplied to the Council)

[1.05] Telephone: not supplied

[1.06] This representation is made in my own name. I accept that it will be published, and I ask to be notified at the email address above of the submission of the plan for examination and of the publication of the Inspector's recommendations.

[1.07] Hearing participation: I wish to appear and be heard at the examination hearings.

[1.08] It is made in the Regulation 19 publication period, which closes at 23:59 on Thursday 12 November 2026. It is submitted by email to SwindonLocalPlan2043@swindon.gov.uk on 12 November 2026, with this document, its annexes and the layer attached.

[1.09] What this representation asks for. The proposed polygons should be added to the relevant green-corridor and biodiversity layers as parts of one Green Infrastructure Network. It supports the site-specific representations made for individual parcels and does not replace them.

2. Summary

[2.01] The plan protects a Green Infrastructure Network "as defined on the Policies Map". The mapped extent decides where that policy applies, so the map is the substantive document. This representation asks the Council to complete it.

[2.02] The Council has mapped the western and southern parts of the Borough, and is currently updating its maps as submissions come in. On the evidence of the existing EN1 layer, what those maps leave out is the smaller connective ground: verges, hedgerows, wooded strips, railway margins, the green between streets, and the soil and plant life they carry. The adopted corridors take in parks, woodland and the larger open spaces; what they lack is the ground between them, and the connections that ground makes. The policy is written to protect links; the map does not show all the links.

[2.03] National policy asks plans to identify and map ecological networks (NPPF 192(a)); the plan commits to a Green Infrastructure Network and protects corridors from severance; and the Council's published EN1 layer already records 40 corridors covering about 900 hectares. The gap is coverage, not principle.

[2.04] The request is that the proposed polygons in the supplied GIS layers, indexed at Annex 2 and mapped at Annex 3, be added to the existing green-corridor and biodiversity layers. It is limited to those polygons. Within the built-up area the recorded network would rise from 14.0 per cent to 25.4 per cent: 1.8 times what is recorded now.

[2.05] That is one amendment rather than a sequence of parcel applications. Three things are asked for, set out at section 10.

3. The proposal

[3.01] The proposal is to add the submitted polygons to the existing green-corridor and biodiversity layers, not to introduce a separate designation or consent regime. Inclusion would bring the identified features within the application of the existing policies, including CSE7. That is the purpose of the request: to ensure that their contribution to the network is considered consistently when development is proposed.

[3.02] What the proposed layers show: land-cover features, classified as woodland and tree cover, scrub, hedgerow and tree line, or grassland and amenity. Each feature records its source, its date and its method. This is strategic mapping of urban ecology and habitats: the network's extent, distribution and connections.

[3.03] What the proposal does not do: it does not say that every mapped feature is of equal value; it does not impose a blanket prohibition on development; and it does not replace the site-by-site assessment that any application still requires. It records the green spaces together as a network so that they can be considered and managed together.

[3.04] Existing and new designations are not in conflict with a whole network map. The map does not replace them, compete with them or require a choice between the two. Existing EN1 areas remain as designated, and any new designation stands on its own case. The network map is the wider record within which they sit.

4. Why a network, and not a set of corridors

[4.01] Corridors are described as routes with ends. What is on the ground is a mesh: cover, gardens, verges, hedges, gaps and a few larger blocks. A corridor record shows a line; a mesh record shows the pieces and where they touch. Soil, litter, dead wood, insects and micro-organisms - the diffusion happens in many directions, and runs in several directions at once: a soil and plant vascular system with arteries, veins and fine capillaries.

[4.02] Inclusion in the mapped network is not a designation. It means that a proposal affecting the land is assessed against the network policies alongside the usual tests.

[4.03] A long-term managed single bramble patch at the junction of Green Road and Constable Road illustrates the principles and outcomes. The verge is about 0.05 hectares of grass, cut by the parish council (Stratton St Margaret); at its northern end the woodland edge becomes bramble, a dome of about 0.03 hectares. The grass is cut and the bramble trimmed back to the same patch each year. Left alone it spreads into the footway and the gardens; flailed flat, the ground holds no permanent cover. Three outcomes, one variable: the mowing pattern, and the cost of the difference is essentially nil.

[4.04] The result is open ground beside permanent varied ground-level cover on a residential road edge. Hedgehogs are recorded in and around the bramble, not in the main strip. The margins carry the use, and not the same margins as the foxes and badgers. A species list cannot stand in for a network record. The same decision - cut here, leave there - is taken on verges across the borough, usually without a record of what was decided or why. Mapping the network makes the pattern visible and repeatable, and turns an accumulation of separate local decisions into settled practice for the long term.

5. The evidence

[5.01] There are two sources. 1) Swindon Borough Council exports from the planning portal - designation layers, the Policies Map and the adopted EN1 green corridors (40 features) - used as supplied, not traced. 2) OpenStreetMap, used two ways: vector features traced by hand, and machine-vision detection run over OSM cartography to identify green cover. OS open data, 2023 aerial imagery and the Natural England Priority Habitat Inventory are reference backdrops only. Each layer records its source and extraction date; licences are in the data note at Annex 1.

[5.02] This is strategic mapping of urban ecology and habitats - land cover, distribution and connections. It does not prove ground truth about habitat conditions. Where the Council or community contributors hold better data, the record can be improved with it. The mechanism to do that already exists: a community mapping application is live, and contributors can supply corrections without the Council commissioning the work.

6. What the map does not show

[6.01] The current record - the Policies Map, the EN1 layer and the entries behind them - records extent. It is a weaker record of management, and of change. Habitats are living, and they change; and the plan takes on long-term responsibilities for monitoring and managing the network. A fixed map serves those duties less well than a record that can be kept current.

[6.02] The network proposed in this representation - the whole-area parcel - enhances the existing mapped network rather than replacing it. It is one whole-area proposal, not a set of separate site proposals, and is distinct from any other proposal before the Council. It adds the smaller green ground between EN1 areas and maps the wider network around them. EN1 sites become locations within a network, not the boundaries of that network. Any site separately designated, now or later, sits within that network: the map accommodates it, does not compete with it, and requires no choice between the two.

[6.03] Habitat- and parcel-scale information about green ground is held by different services and organisations. As it stands, there is no single coordinated route for sharing what is known about green space across the

Borough as a connected whole. A published layer with versioned data control, data notes and a submission process would supply one, so that the duties the plan takes on can be measured against a current record.

7. What the network is for: the baseline

[7.01] Policy CSE11 of the Swindon Local Plan 2043 sets the aim of delivering "a significant net gain in the Borough's overall biodiversity value" (supporting text, 8.55). A net gain can only be measured against what exists.

[7.02] Mapping the network establishes a spatial baseline of its extent, distribution and connections. That baseline supports ecological management across the network as a whole, rather than repeated decisions about whether individual parcels are sufficiently important in isolation. Further mapping and community observations can improve the record over time.

[7.03] Ecological management needs a record of the ground being managed and how its parts relate. Coarse zoning and the distribution of green cover provide a network-scale baseline, whereas habitat surveys answer a different question. The two have different remits, and one does not replace the other.

[7.04] The numbers, as the layer currently stands. Measured inside the Council's own urban area envelope, with overlaps removed so that nothing is counted twice. Method: all geometry in EPSG:27700; classes taken from the layer's own feature classes; each group unioned before measurement; the whole clipped to the Council's published urban envelope. The script is reproducible and the layer file is available on request.

Measure	Hectares	Share of the urban area
Urban built-up area (Council envelope)	6,483	100%
Existing mapped green, including the adopted EN1 corridors	908	14.0%
Adopted EN1 corridors alone	788	12.2%
Proposed additions, not already existing green	740	11.4%
Combined recorded network	1,648	25.4%

[7.05] The uplift. Including the additions would take the recorded network from 908 hectares to 1,648: 1.8 times the existing mapped green, and 25.4 per cent of the built-up area.

[7.06] What the figures cover. The layer now records the great majority of the green ground in the urban area: habitat zones derived from OpenStreetMap, garden density across residential blocks, and the proposed additions. It is not a census. Habitat classes are mapped by proxy rather than survey; the union removes overlaps; the envelope is the Council's own polygon; the EN1 figure is the portion inside it. Further metrics can be drawn from the same layers as they are needed.

[7.07] A living record. This submission is a substantial addition to the mapped network, not a claim that every green feature has now been recorded. The layer can remain open to additions and corrections. A community mapping app is already live, which lets local groups contribute observations and mapping without the Council commissioning the work, at no cost to the Council.

8. Consistency, economy and severability

[8.01] Under the current application-based system, council designation committees could legitimately be swamped with hundreds of separate parcel requests, even on the same parcel. Network mapping, and then planning for management, avoids those problems entirely and cleanly.

[8.02] Separate decisions produce inconsistent answers. Two identical pieces of green should not receive opposite answers because one request arrived in March and the other in November. A map applies one test, in the same way, to every feature on it, and the test is simple: is the ground open and green? If it is, it is recorded, and it enters the management plan that follows.

[8.03] The mapping is supplied once, for inclusion, rather than generated through repeated parcel applications. The policy mechanism and GIS layers already exist, and the community contribution process would support further work without Council-funded commissions.

[8.04] Severability. If a particular polygon is found wanting, it can be removed or redrawn without the framework falling.

[8.05] Whether a feature is called a corridor, a link, a stepping stone, an open space or a verge does not change whether it is green and whether it connects. Those are the two questions the map answers, and they are the only two that matter to the policy. Whole-network mapping eases designation decisions and moves the work on into management.

[8.06] If the reply is that the principle is accepted and the detail will be considered at the next review, the omitted parts of the network remain outside its mapped extent in the meantime. Inclusion is not the opposite of that. It changes what the record contains, and therefore what the policies are applied to: the network as it exists, rather than the parts of it that were mapped first.

[8.07] Including the supplied polygons puts the principle into practice now.

9. Contrary evidence and answers

[9.01] "The map already reflects the Green Infrastructure Strategy." Where the Council's own corridors end at an unmapped gap, that is an inconsistency inside its own network, not a matter of interpretation.

[9.02] "Roads and boundaries break connectivity." They do, and the NPPF's use of stepping stones accepts discontinuity. Road risk is a reason to identify and safeguard crossing points and the green beside them, not a reason to leave them off the map.

[9.03] "Small patches have low ecological value." For a link the question is whether it links, not whether it is rich. CSE7(2) counts placemaking and landscape value as well as ecological value. Low value now does not imply low value in future.

[9.04] "A network means everything is protected." The request is limited to the proposed polygons supplied with this representation and shown at Annex 3. Inclusion does not impose a blanket prohibition on development; it tells the Council where the network exists so that a proposal can take account of it.

[9.05] "The data is not accurate enough." It is a strategic-scale land-cover record with sources and dates stated, not a boundary survey, and no legal boundary is claimed. That is the standard of the Council's own designation layers. If better data exists, the map should be corrected with it.

[9.06] "This is a matter for the neighbourhood plan." Two parish areas are covered, and a network does not stop at a parish boundary. A whole network map is the only document with the spatial reach to answer the question.

[9.07] "It would cost too much." No new survey is required. The mapping, its method and its data notes are supplied with this representation, and a community mapping application is already live and free to use. The cost of not holding the record does not disappear; it falls on each application, which has to establish the same facts again.

[9.08] "There are more important things to care about." Not in competition with them. This is a record of ground that already exists, in the places people live. Access to green space, vegetation and the microbiomes they carry is associated with positive community activity, health and individual wellbeing.

[9.09] "This is not the right policy or process for it." Applying for each parcel separately would be entirely within both. Nothing in this representation steps outside the plan's own policy or the Council's own procedure; it uses them. The single map is chosen in place of that route because the same questions would otherwise be asked, and answered, several hundred times over.

10. What is asked

[10.01] Three requests, each answerable on its own. The first is the substantive one. The second and third support it, and stand without it.

[10.02] Request 1: the additions. That the Council include the proposed polygons supplied with this representation in the relevant green-corridor and biodiversity layers, as additions to the existing mapped network. They are indexed at Annex 2 and mapped at Annex 3. They are submitted as one network-wide proposal rather than as a series of parcel applications, because the subject is a network. Existing EN1 polygons are unchanged, and no new designation is sought: inclusion applies the policies the plan already carries.

[10.03] Request 2: the record. That the layer and its data note (Annex 1) be published with the plan, so that the record can be corrected, maintained and used as a spatial baseline for network-scale ecological management. The record should remain open to further additions and community contributions. The mechanism for that already exists, and costs the Council nothing to use.

[10.04] Request 3: the account. A written account of what the Council's records currently show, and of the reasoning applied: how the land on the proposed polygons is treated on the Policies Map; whether and how it appears in the Green Infrastructure Strategy and its underlying mapping; whether it was included in the Open Space Assessment; and, where a feature or an area has been excluded, the criteria applied and the evidence relied on. If there is an established route by which green infrastructure records are updated between plan reviews, it would be helpful to know what it is. If there is none, that is a useful answer in itself.

[10.05] How the evidence is supplied. It is presented as one network. It can equally be supplied parcel by parcel if the Council's process requires it, and it has been prepared in a form that allows that. It is presented whole because the subject is, in fact, one network. That reduces the evidential burden on each future EN1 designation, which no longer has to demonstrate that its area is part of a corridor, and moves the effort to management of the network, or to statutory protection where that is appropriate.

11. Limits and closing

[11.01] What is not required. Nothing here requires the Council to commission work, convene a committee, or decide anything about designation. Accepting the mapping eases designation work rather than adding to it, and it lets the work move on into management. The mapping exists. If the Council wants to use it, it is there; if a parish wants to add to it, the route is open; if neither happens, the record is still more complete than it was.

[11.02] The limits, stated plainly.

The map is a strategic mapping of urban ecology and habitats, not a habitat survey and not a measured boundary. No separate designation or consent regime is sought; the request is inclusion through the existing policy and GIS framework. No claim is made that every mapped feature is of equal value; the map records presence and connection, not quality. Any site-specific detail sits in the separate parcel representations themselves, and is not included here.

[11.03] I am grateful for the chance to put this on the record. I would be glad to walk any part of the network with an officer, to supply the layer files and the data note in whatever format is useful, or to give evidence at the examination hearings.

[11.04] Signed: Daniel Miller

[11.05] Dated: 12 November 2026

Annex 1: data note

[1.1] What follows is the note that should accompany the layer, not a description of a survey. It states what each layer is, where it came from, what it may be used for, and what it does not show.

Layer	Source	Licence	Date taken	Used for	Does not show
Adopted EN1 green corridors (40 features)	Swindon Borough Council, planning portal, adopted Local Plan layer	Open Government Licence	2026-11-04	Existing context and precedent: the Council's own mapped corridors, and where they stop	The proposed additions
Council designation layers (Policies Map extract)	Swindon Borough Council, plan publication	Open Government Licence	2026-11	Existing mapped context for the proposed additions	Anything not designated; boundaries are as published
OpenStreetMap base data	OpenStreetMap contributors	ODbL 1.0 - attribution and share-alike	2026-11-12 (frozen)	Base mapping, roads, buildings, water, footpaths; some green features traced from it	Positional accuracy guarantees; it is crowd-sourced and changes continuously
OS OpenData products	Ordnance Survey	Open Government Licence	2026-11	Reference backdrop for tracing	Detail below the product's scale
Aerial imagery, 2023	Supplied backdrop	Reference only; not redistributed	2023	Tracing canopy, scrub and verge	Ground conditions since 2023; species; ownership
Natural England Priority Habitat Inventory	Natural England	Open Government Licence	2026-11		
Wiltshire and Swindon Local Nature Recovery Strategy	Council / partnership publication	As published	2026-11	Context for strategic significance	Site-level detail

[1.2] What is claimed. Each proposed polygon records green land cover traced and classified from the backdrops above, at strategic scale. The mapping records the network's extent, distribution and connections, not habitat condition. Waterways, roads and railway lines are shown for context only; water is not a proposed inclusion category.

[11.2a] Existing and proposed features. The maps show existing green areas and the proposed polygons together. The proposal is the set of polygons identified in the supplied GIS layers; nothing existing is amended.

[1.3] What is not claimed. No legal boundary. No positional accuracy beyond strategic scale. No habitat survey. No ownership. Where a feature's source cannot be established, the data note says so rather than guessing.

[1.4] Version. The layer relied on in this representation was frozen on 12 November 2026. Later edits to OpenStreetMap or to Council layers are not part of what is filed.

[1.5] Attribution to carry on any copy of the map: "Â© OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL)". Council designation data is reproduced under the Open Government Licence.

Annex 2: schedule of anchors

[2.1] This schedule lists seventy features of the network - country parks, large open spaces, allotments, priority habitat, the village green, the railway woodland edge, the stepping-stone links and the adopted EN1 corridors. For each it records its class and mapped area. Some are already mapped; the proposed polygons are identified in the supplied GIS layers and shown on the figures.

[2.2] The remaining proposed layers - canopy, verges, hedgerow runs and small green spaces - are numerous and are available for direct download from the community web application, and can be supplied directly on request. They are part of the request; this table is the index, not the limit. The layer version is frozen as stated at Annex 1 [1.4].

Ref	Feature	Class	Area (ha)
N01	Coate Water Country Park (SSSI & LNR, ~81 ha)	country park core	81.36
N02	Lydiard Country Park (Grade II* Registered Historic Park & Garden)	country park core	146.40
N03	Mouldon Hill Country Park	country park core	69.96
N04	Peatmoor Lagoon & Local Nature Reserve (~15 ha)	country park core	12.31
N05	Shaw Forest Community Woodland	country park core	97.86
N06	Stanton Country Park & Nature Reserve	country park core	133.84
N07	Greenbridge & Stratton St Margaret Eastern Open Space	open space large	9.79
N08	Meadowcroft Playing Fields & Upper Stratton Recreation Ground	open space large	4.91
N09	Penhill Recreation Ground & Pinehurst Green Spaces	open space large	13.36
N10	St Lukes & Merton Avenue Open Space	open space large	8.31
N11	St Marks / Pinehurst Southern Open Space	open space large	17.23
N12	Gorse Hill / Wheeler Avenue Allotments (SN2 7HN, Central Swindon North Parish Council)	allotments community growing	1.80
N13	allotment	amenity allotments	0.41
N14	allotments	amenity allotments	1.39
N15	allotments	amenity allotments	0.91
N16	Ash Corner / Iffley N-S Railway Woodland Spine (incl. s.41 Priority Woodland)	high value habitat	3.92
N17	Natural England s.41 Priority Habitat: Deciduous Woodland (DWOOD)	high value habitat	1.27
N18	Seven Fields Local Nature Reserve & Penhill Copse	high value habitat	39.54
N19	Stratton Woods & Kingsdown Ecological Core	high value habitat	60.57
N20	Kembrey Park Eastern Woodland & Grassland Buffer	kembrey wild edge	0.52
N21	Kembrey Park Northern Boundary Tree Belt (Wheeler Ave / Constable Rd Edge)	kembrey wild edge	0.26
N22	Constable Road Village Green	village green	0.02
N23	Constable Road parcel (village green, strip, verge and bramble)	wildlife corridor	0.32
N24	River Ray Parkway & Floodplain Corridor (Strategic Blue-Green Spine)	link route stepping stone	-
N25	Southern Ecological Link: Coate Water SSSI to North Wessex Downs	link route stepping stone	-
N26	Western Strategic Movement Arc: River Ray & West Swindon Country Parks	link route stepping stone	-
N27	extra urban	link route stepping stone	-
N28	informal regular footpath	link route stepping stone	-

Ref	Feature	Class	Area (ha)
N29	old drove way/hedges	link route stepping stone	-
N30	route to country side	link route stepping stone	-
N31	EN1 Green Corridor 01	en1 green corridor	10.72
N32	EN1 Green Corridor 02	en1 green corridor	96.00
N33	EN1 Green Corridor 03	en1 green corridor	0.28
N34	EN1 Green Corridor 04	en1 green corridor	0.66
N35	EN1 Green Corridor 05	en1 green corridor	1.01
N36	EN1 Green Corridor 06	en1 green corridor	2.45
N37	EN1 Green Corridor 07	en1 green corridor	6.23
N38	EN1 Green Corridor 08	en1 green corridor	4.68
N39	EN1 Green Corridor 09	en1 green corridor	0.95
N40	EN1 Green Corridor 10	en1 green corridor	1.26
N41	EN1 Green Corridor 11	en1 green corridor	11.12
N42	EN1 Green Corridor 12	en1 green corridor	2.47
N43	EN1 Green Corridor 13	en1 green corridor	5.30
N44	EN1 Green Corridor 14	en1 green corridor	52.55
N45	EN1 Green Corridor 15	en1 green corridor	4.87
N46	EN1 Green Corridor 16	en1 green corridor	20.05
N47	EN1 Green Corridor 17	en1 green corridor	36.69
N48	EN1 Green Corridor 18	en1 green corridor	6.23
N49	EN1 Green Corridor 19	en1 green corridor	5.07
N50	EN1 Green Corridor 20	en1 green corridor	42.51
N51	EN1 Green Corridor 21	en1 green corridor	3.58
N52	EN1 Green Corridor 22	en1 green corridor	39.27
N53	EN1 Green Corridor 23	en1 green corridor	306.01
N54	EN1 Green Corridor 24	en1 green corridor	4.36
N55	EN1 Green Corridor 25	en1 green corridor	1.49
N56	EN1 Green Corridor 26	en1 green corridor	4.64
N57	EN1 Green Corridor 27	en1 green corridor	0.81
N58	EN1 Green Corridor 28	en1 green corridor	1.85
N59	EN1 Green Corridor 29	en1 green corridor	3.13
N60	EN1 Green Corridor 30	en1 green corridor	50.45
N61	EN1 Green Corridor 31	en1 green corridor	9.83
N62	EN1 Green Corridor 32	en1 green corridor	6.69
N63	EN1 Green Corridor 33	en1 green corridor	82.02
N64	EN1 Green Corridor 34	en1 green corridor	25.20
N65	EN1 Green Corridor 35	en1 green corridor	6.34
N66	EN1 Green Corridor 36	en1 green corridor	10.66
N67	EN1 Green Corridor 37	en1 green corridor	9.10
N68	EN1 Green Corridor 38	en1 green corridor	5.98
N69	EN1 Green Corridor 39	en1 green corridor	11.18
N70	EN1 Green Corridor 40	en1 green corridor	4.87

[2.3] Reading the table. The areas are those of the mapped footprints. Routes appear for orientation. Which of these features are proposed polygons is a matter of the supplied GIS layers, not of this table.

Annex 3: network maps

[3.1] Figure 2 shows the layer within the Swindon study area: green space and woodland, the adopted EN1 corridors, the proposed additions, the railway, the M4 and the A419, and the main rivers. There is no raster base map. Roads, railway and rivers are drawn for orientation only, so that the proposals can be read without streets and buildings competing with them.

[3.2] Figures 3a to 3i are nine full-page detail views at about 4.3 by 5.8 kilometres - large enough to show the network, small enough to read the proposals. Between them they cover every proposed polygon. The pages overlap; they are there to show coverage, not to define boundaries.

[3.3] The nine detail pages carry no legend of their own; the key below applies to all of them, and to Figure 2. Existing green spaces and woodlands are drawn solid green, in varied tones and hatches, so that the family of green can be read at a glance. The proposed additions are an orange fill at 50 per cent with a solid orange outline; proposed links are solid orange lines.

Symbol	Meaning
Dark green, no outline	Adopted EN1 corridor
Green, hatched and toned	Existing mapped green space and woodland, by cover type
Pale orange, no outline	Habitat outside existing green, proposed for inclusion
Orange fill with orange outline	Selected proposal polygons, as supplied
Orange line	Proposed link
Blue line	Watercourse
Green line, hatched	Railway
Black, heavy	M4 and A419
Grey outline, dashed	Extent of each detail page

Figure 2 - the network layer, Swindon study area
green space and woodland, adopted EN1 corridors, proposals, railway, M4 and A419

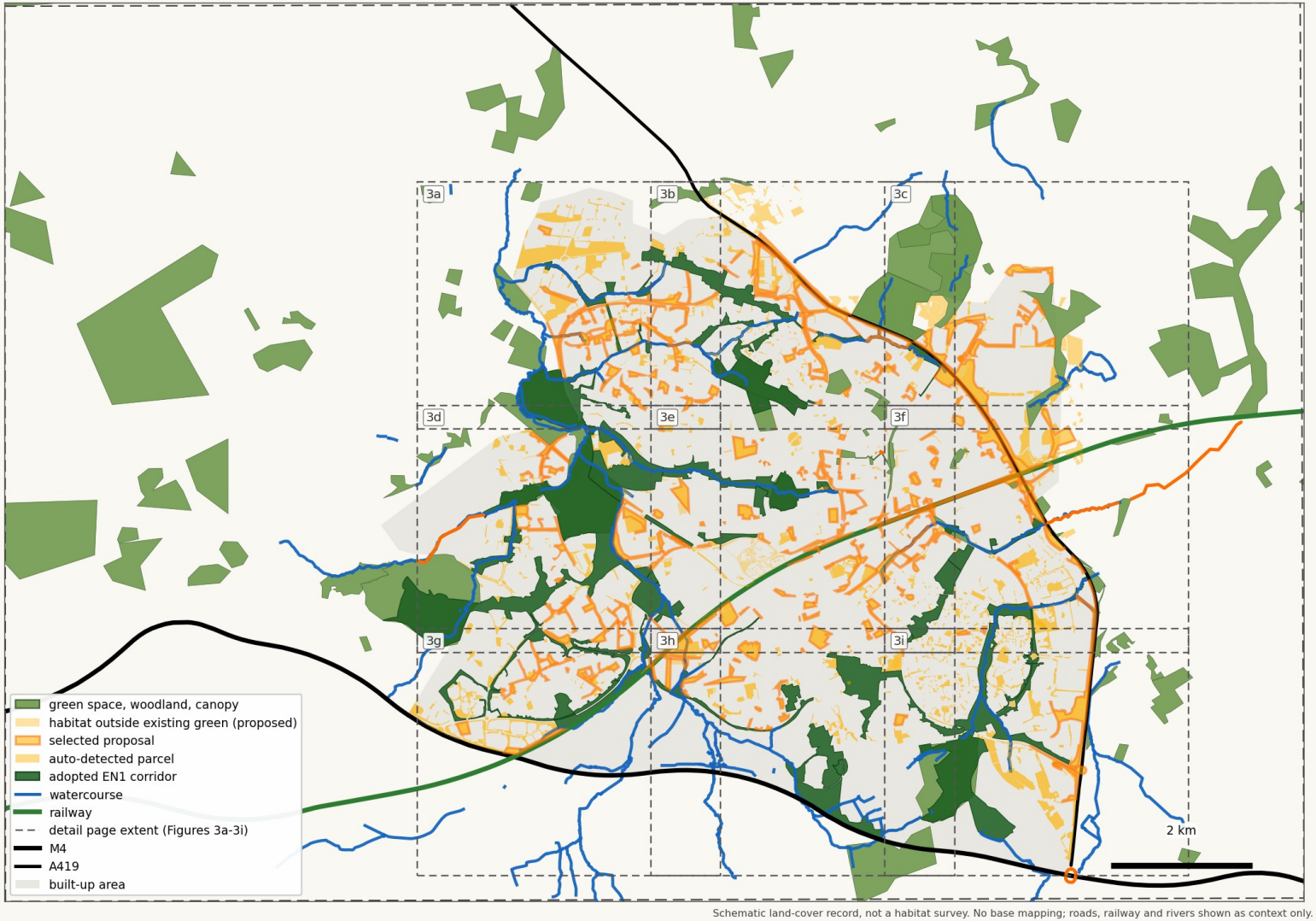


Figure 2. The network layer, Swindon study area. Schematic land-cover record, not a habitat survey.

Figure 3a - network layer, detail 1 of 9

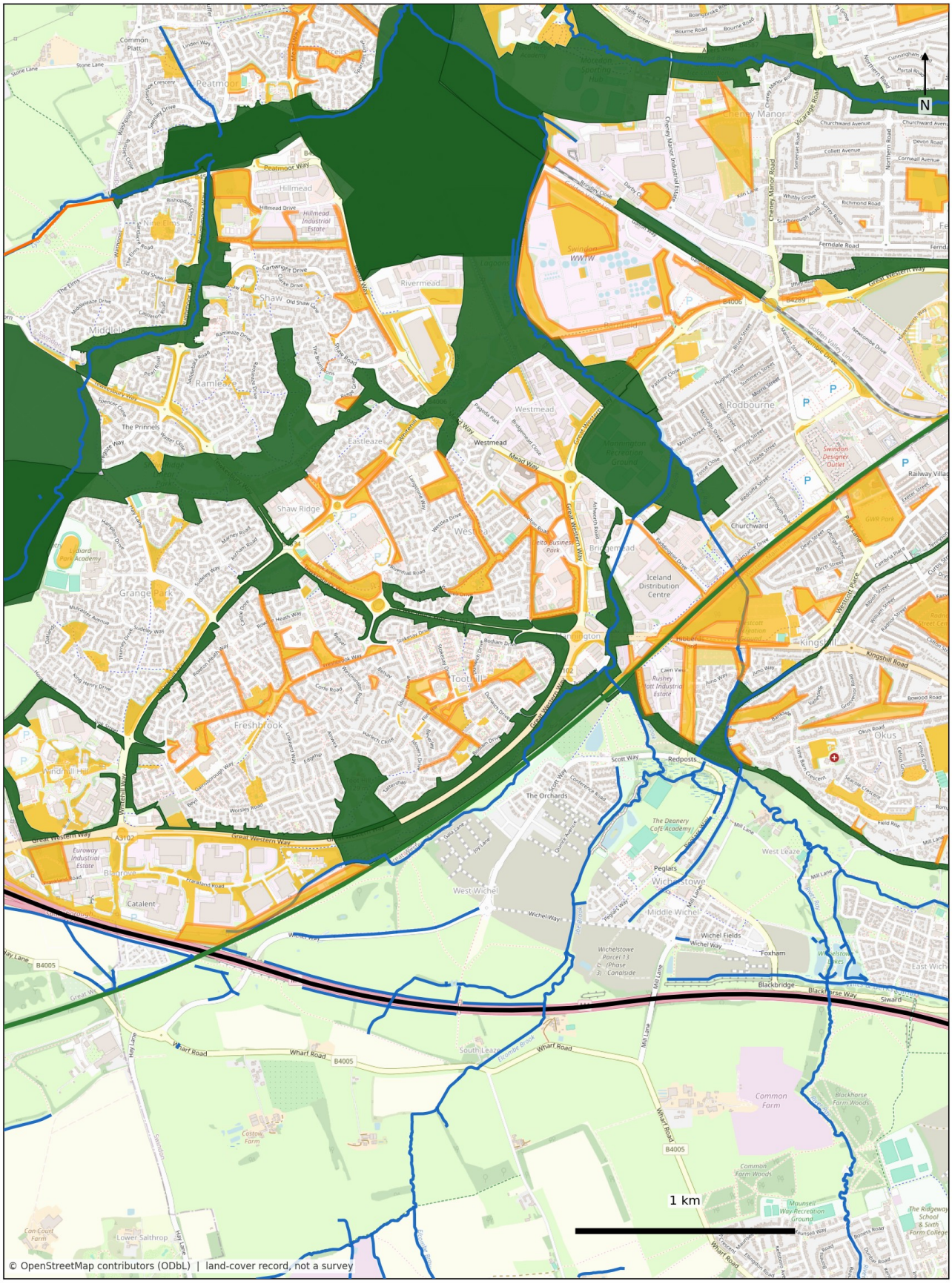


Figure 3a. Network layer, detail 1 of 9.

Figure 3b - network layer, detail 2 of 9

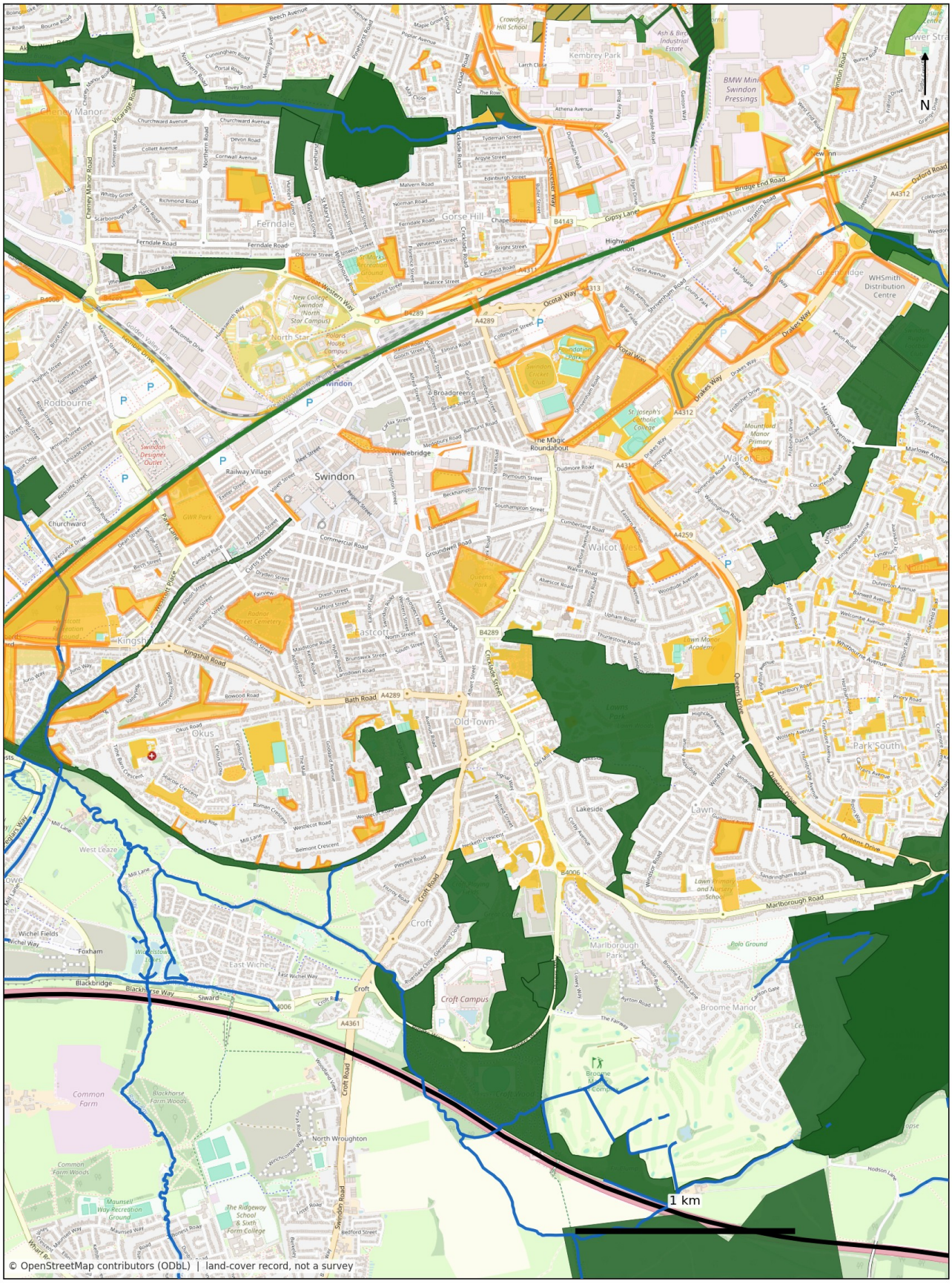


Figure 3b. Network layer, detail 2 of 9.

Figure 3c - network layer, detail 3 of 9

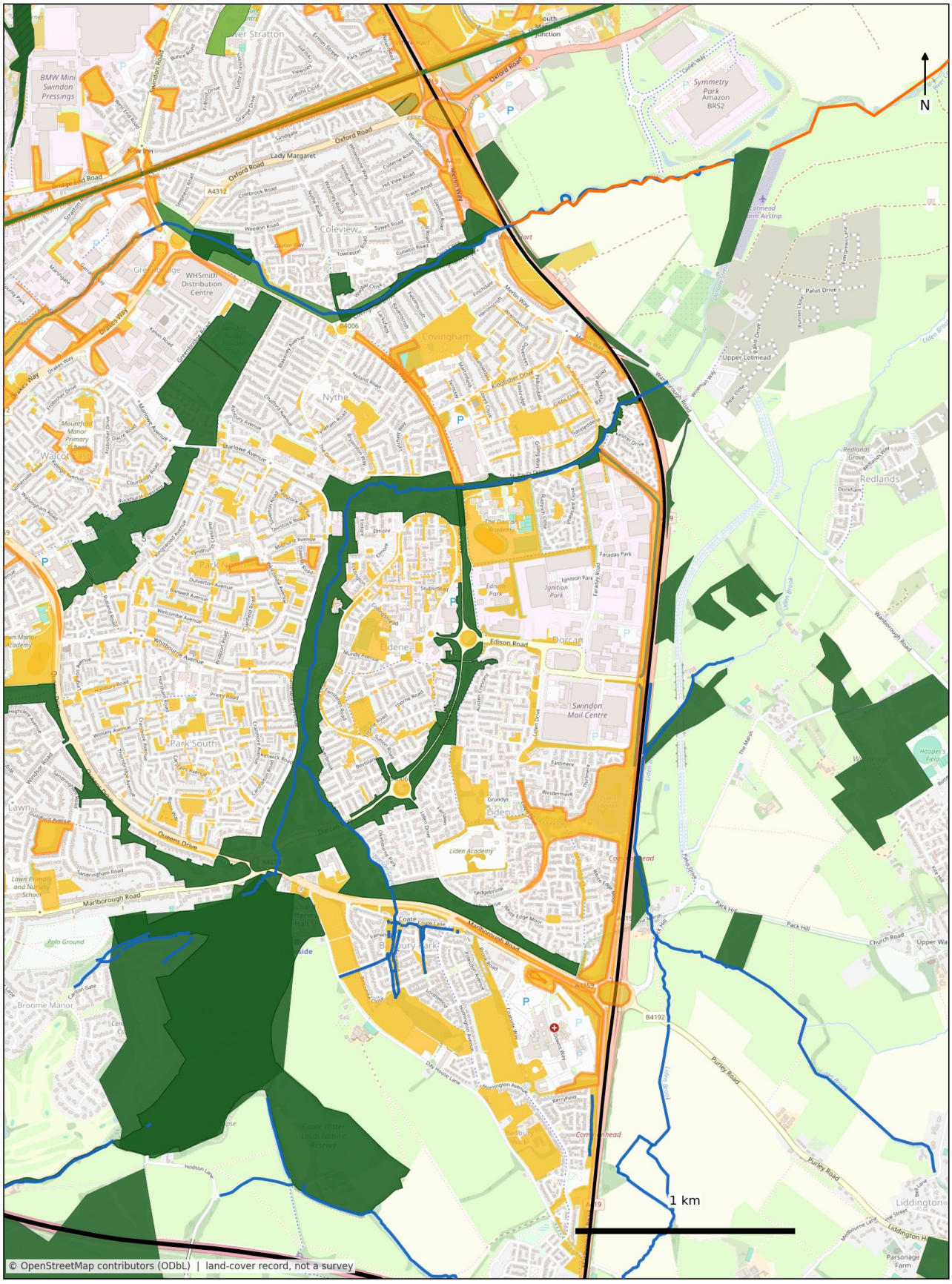


Figure 3c. Network layer, detail 3 of 9.

Figure 3d - network layer, detail 4 of 9

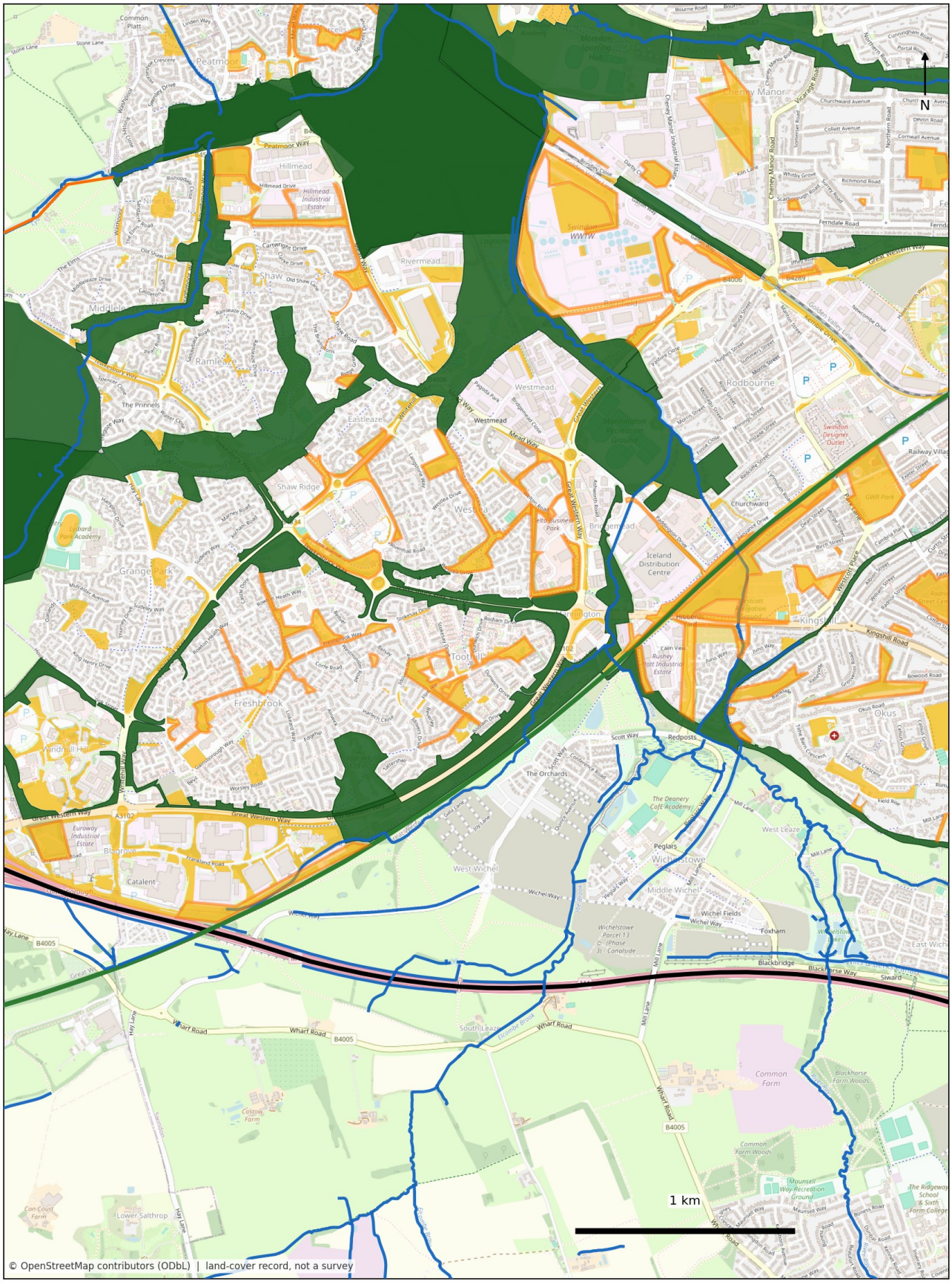


Figure 3d. Network layer, detail 4 of 9.

Figure 3e - network layer, detail 5 of 9

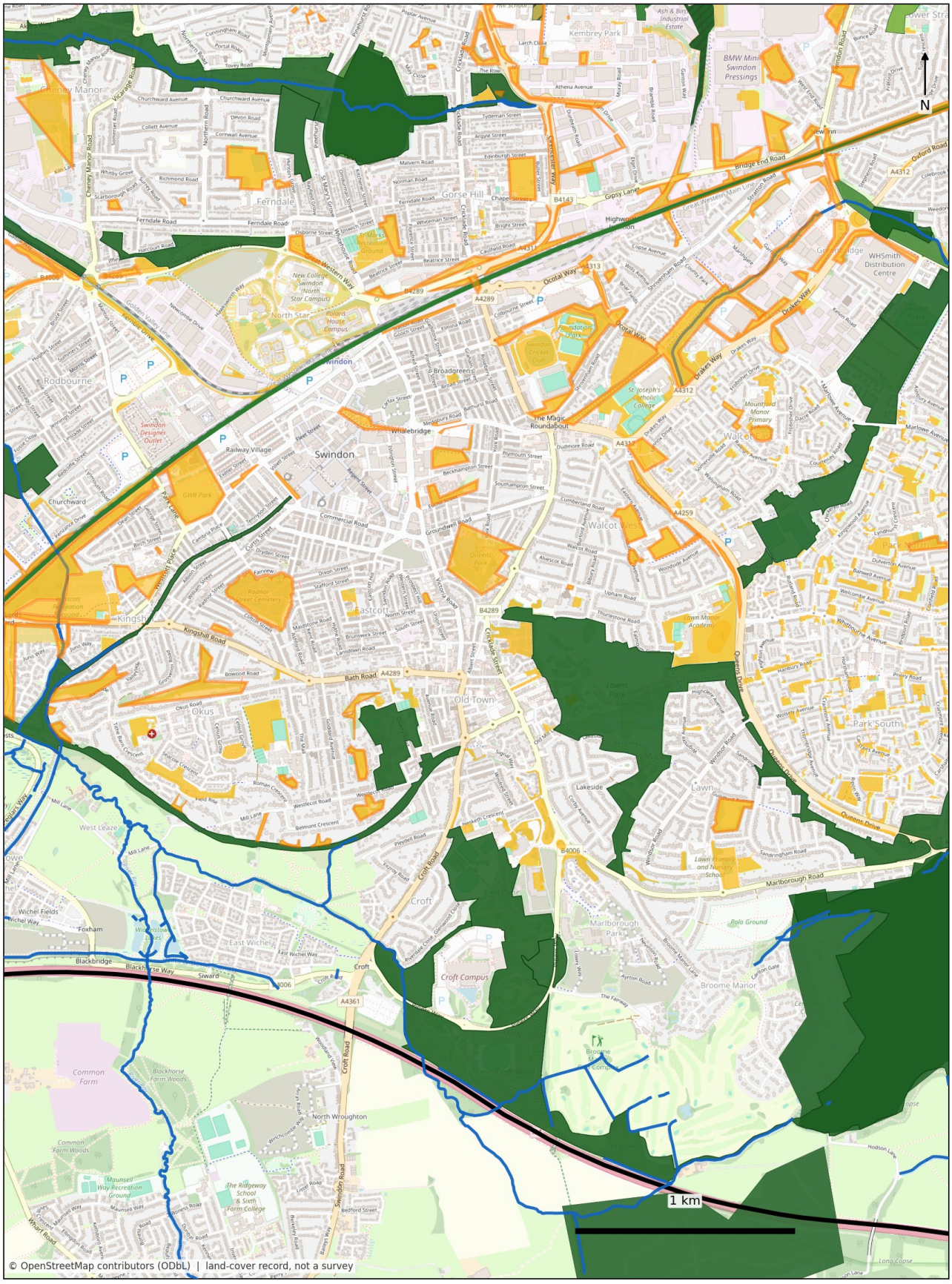


Figure 3e. Network layer, detail 5 of 9.

Figure 3f - network layer, detail 6 of 9

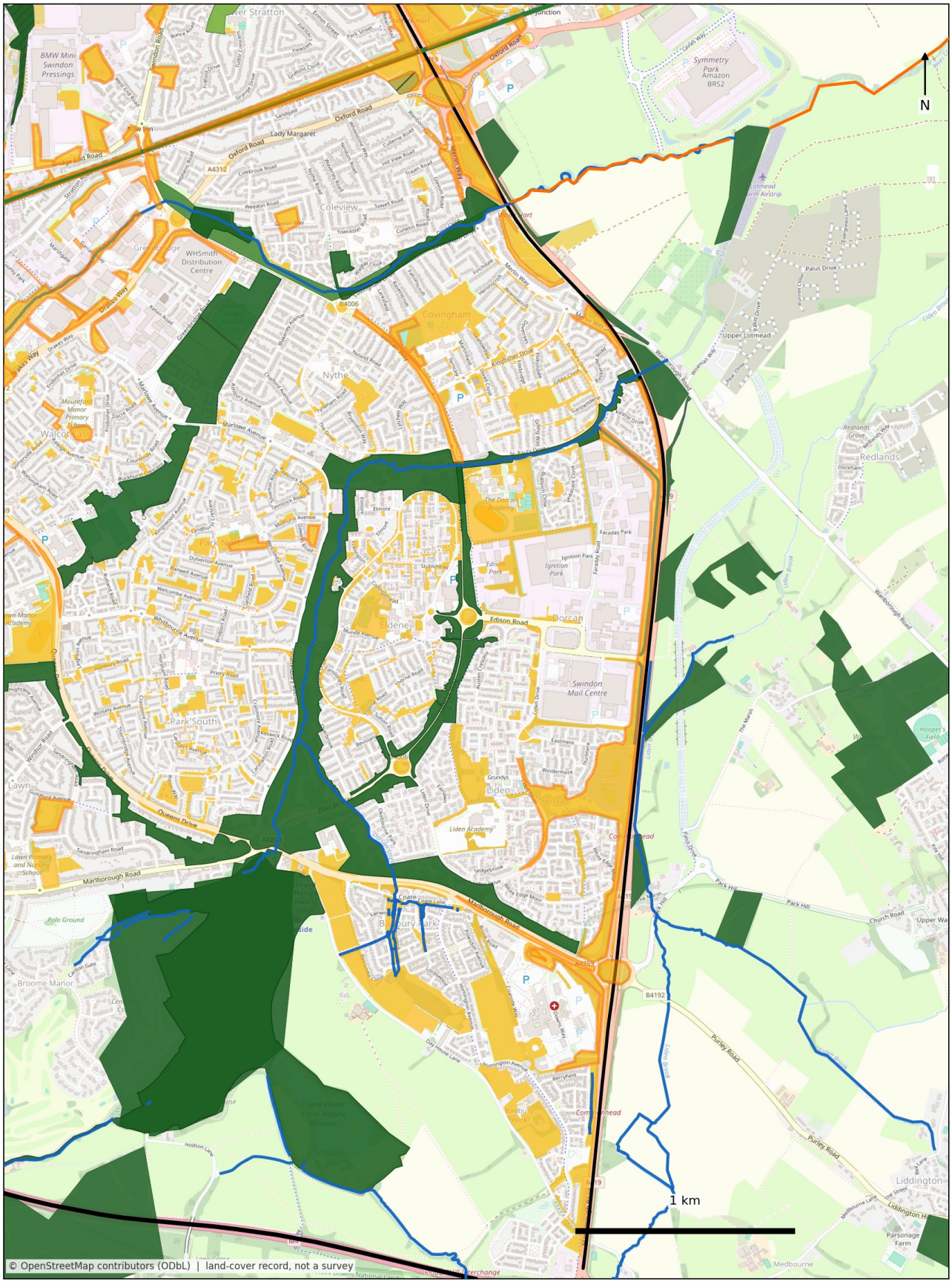


Figure 3f. Network layer, detail 6 of 9.

Figure 3g - network layer, detail 7 of 9

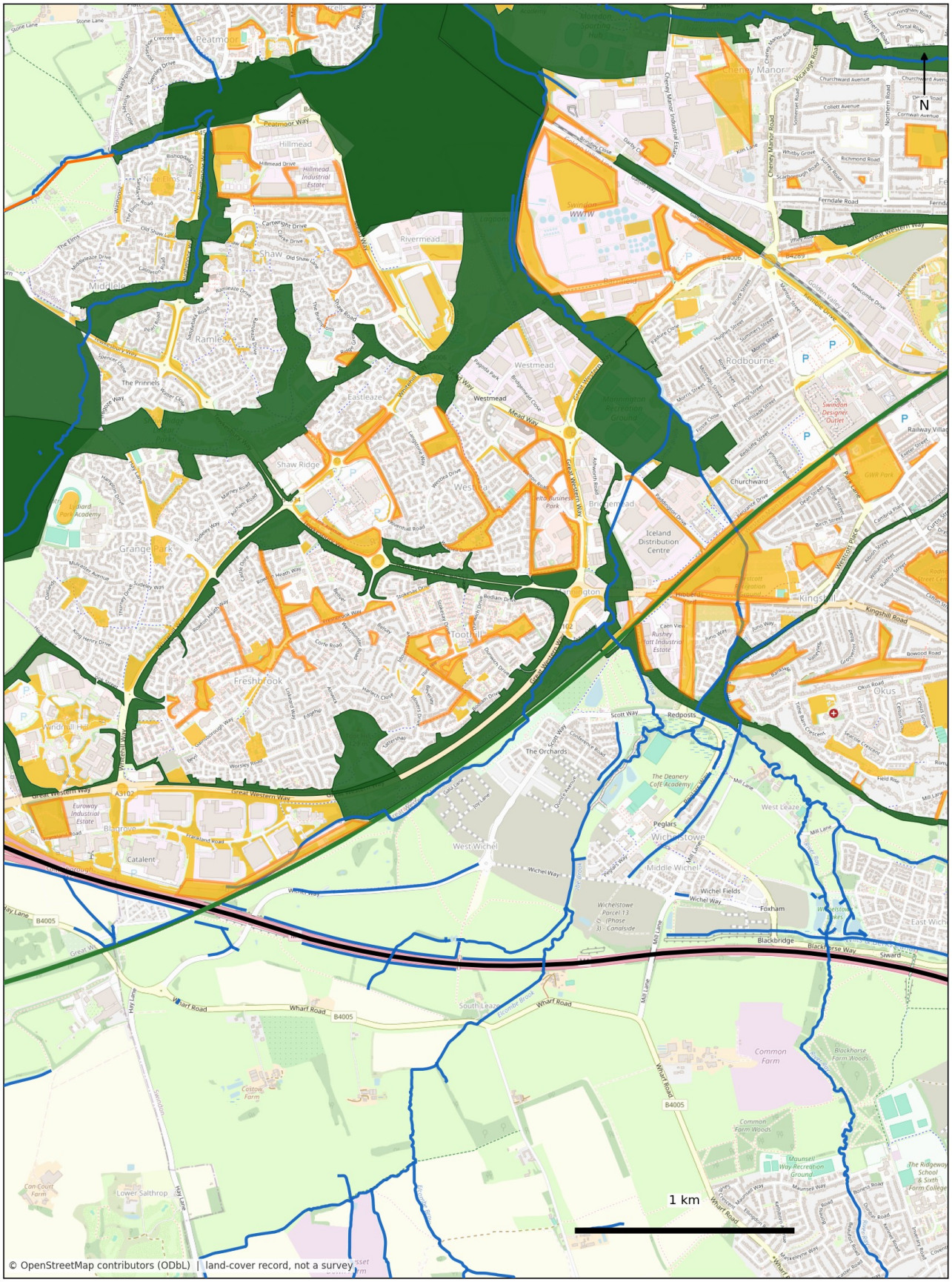


Figure 3g. Network layer, detail 7 of 9.

Figure 3h - network layer, detail 8 of 9

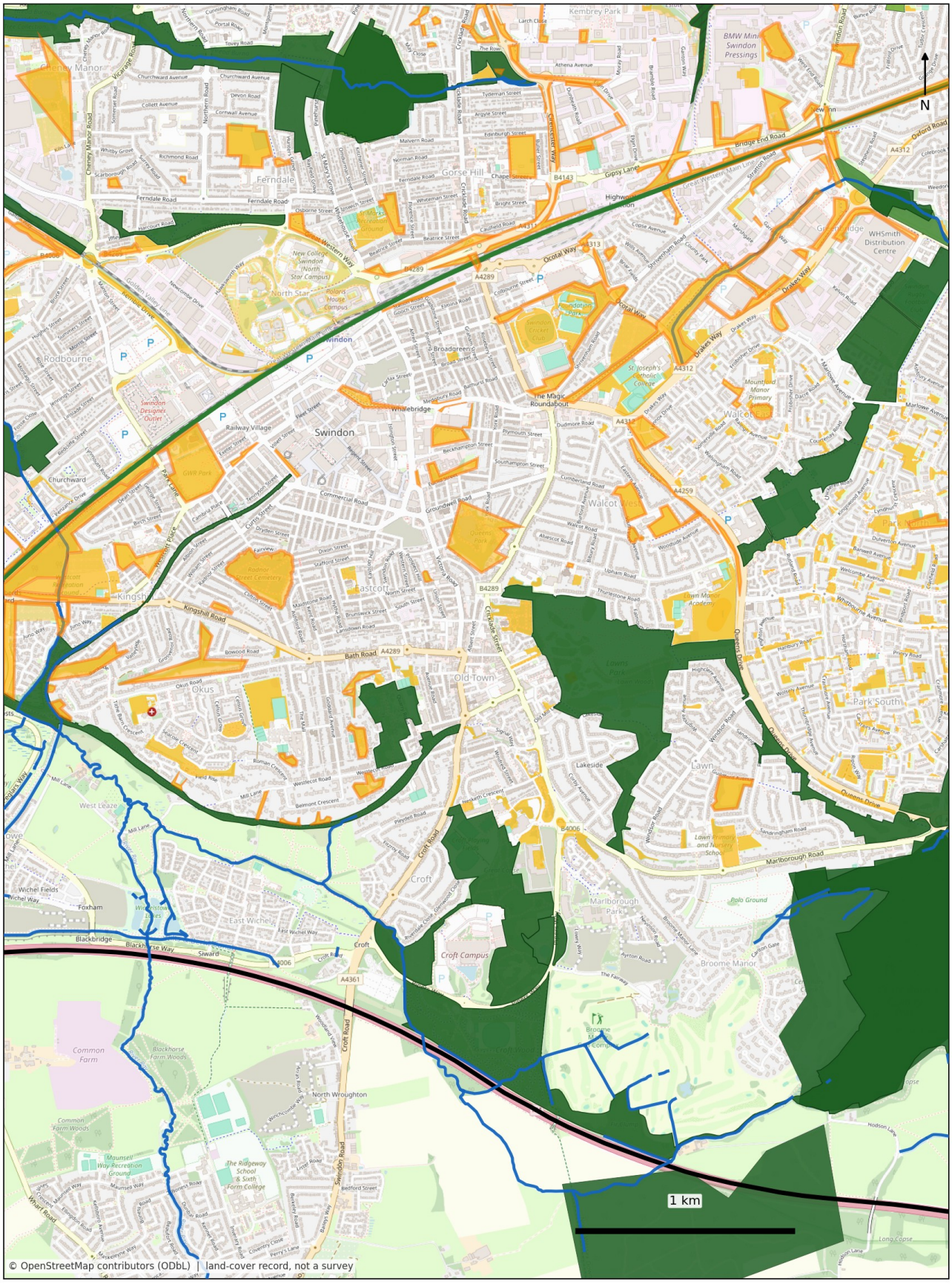


Figure 3h. Network layer, detail 8 of 9.

Figure 3i - network layer, detail 9 of 9

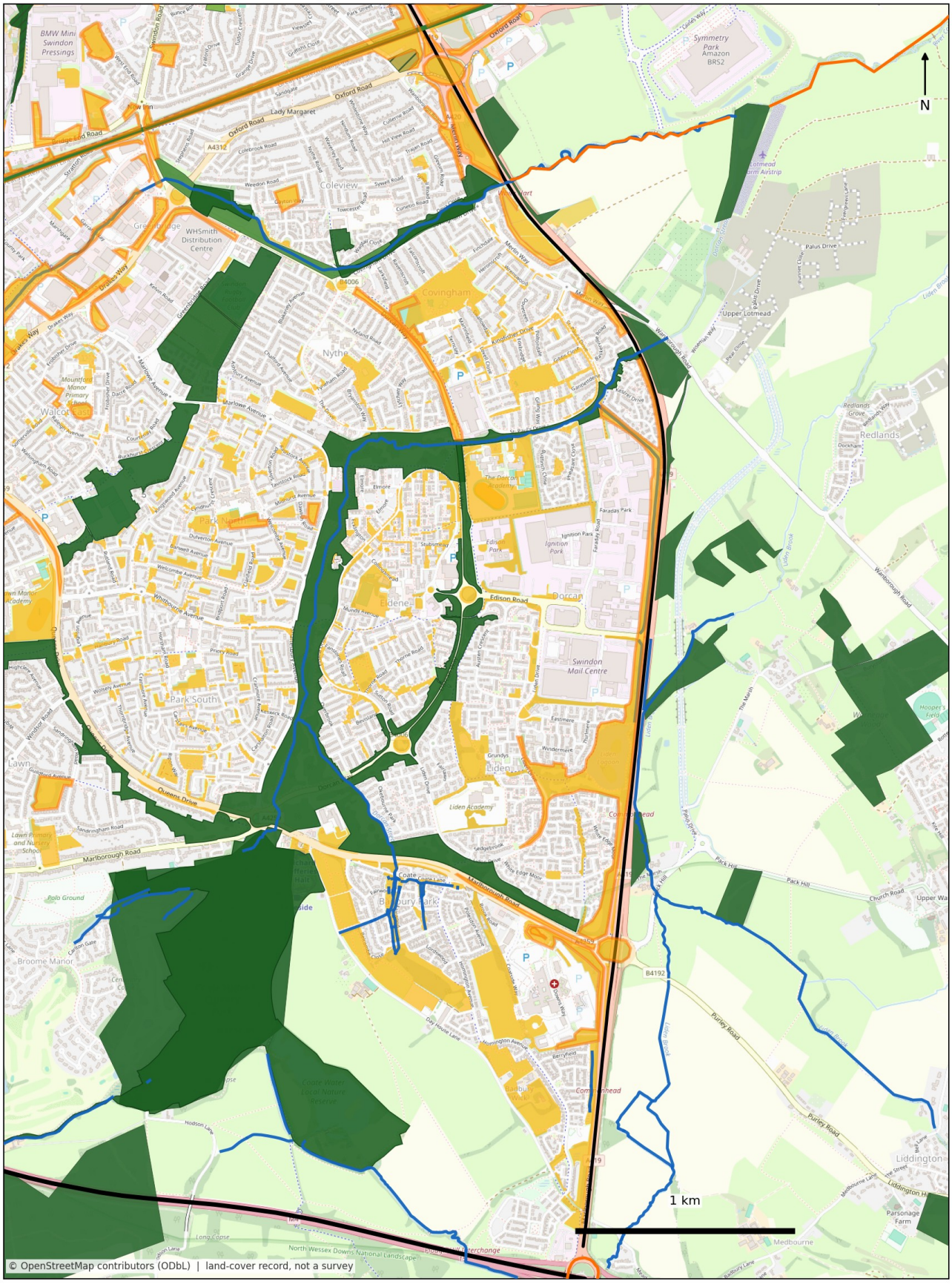


Figure 3i. Network layer, detail 9 of 9.

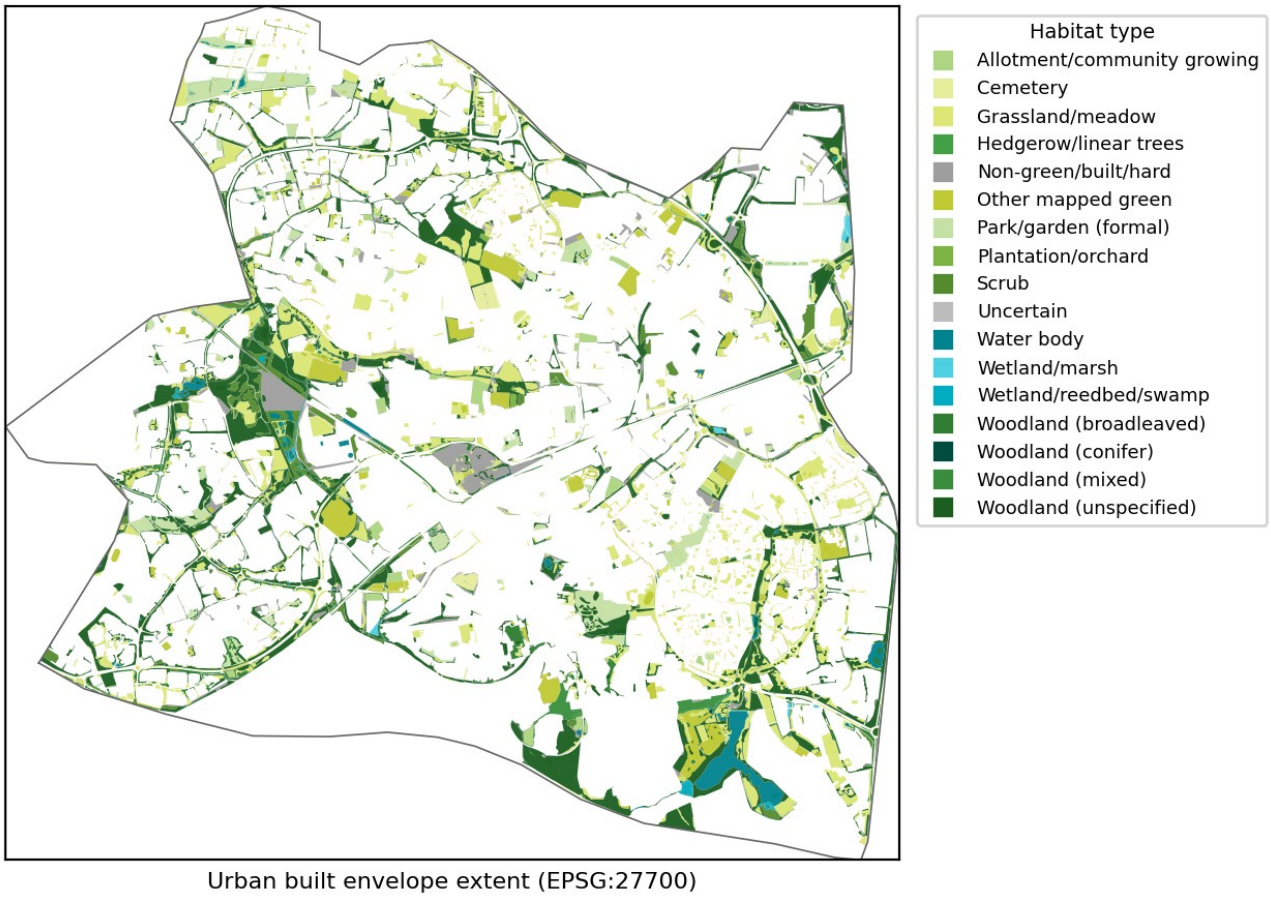


Figure 4. Habitat zones across the urban area, extracted from OpenStreetMap by machine learning. Reported map classes only, urban-clipped.

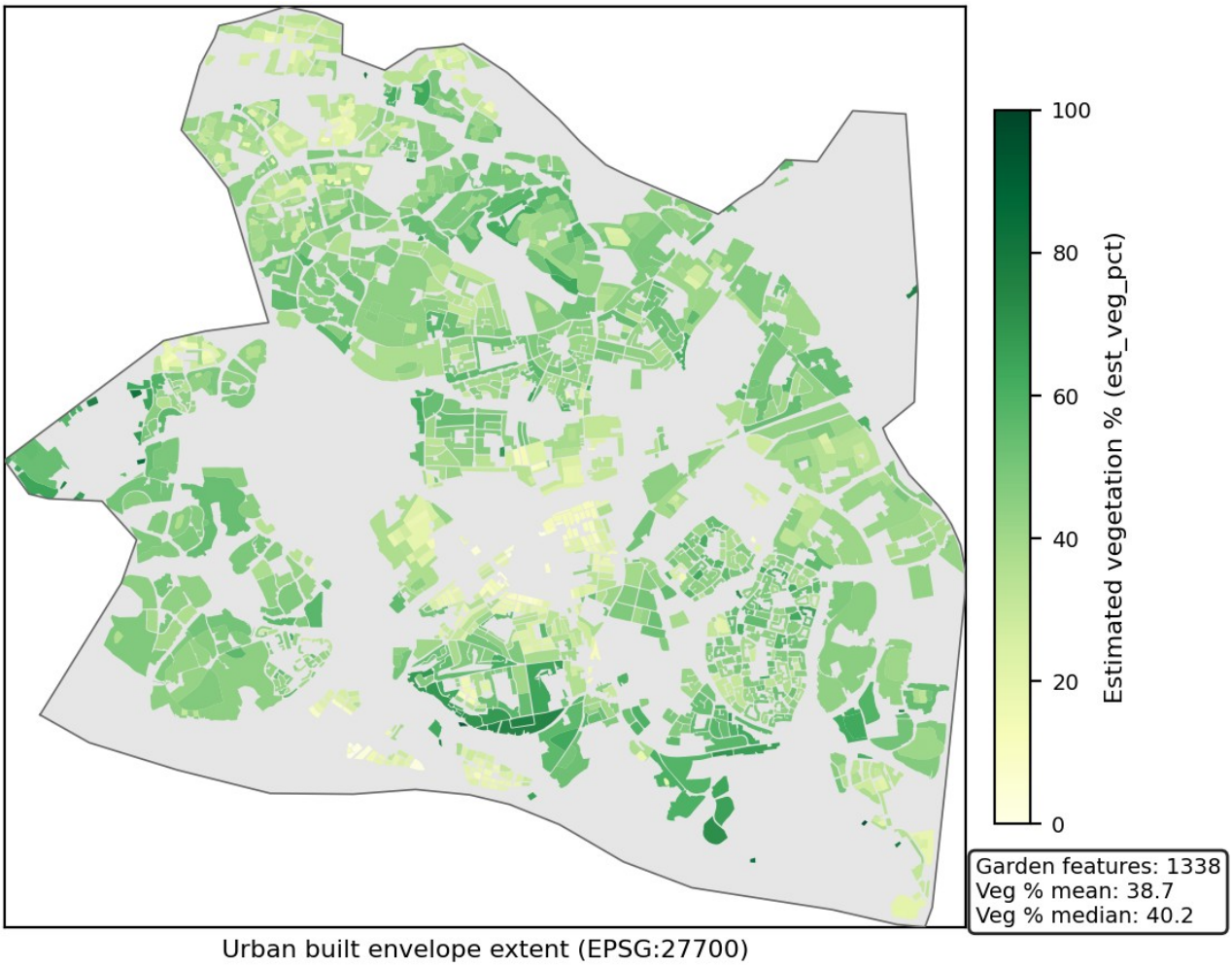


Figure 5. Garden density across residential blocks, extracted from satellite imagery and OpenStreetMap by machine learning. 1,338 garden features; median 40.2 per cent vegetation cover. Urban-clipped, non-garden areas masked.

[3.4] The habitat composition of the existing EN1 corridors, 543.6 hectares of habitat-classified ground, is closely similar to that of the proposed additions at 702.5 hectares. Woodland dominates both, grassland and scrub make up comparable shares, and water and built ground are minor in each.

[3.5] That similarity is the point. The request is not for a new category of land or a different kind of designation. It is the same kind of ground, at the same order of magnitude, as the network the plan already carries: a natural next stage rather than a different proposition.

[3.6] These are habitat-classified areas only, so the totals are lower than the network areas given in section 7. They compare composition, not extent, and the two measures should not be read against each other. The comparison is EN1 against the additions; it excludes other existing mapped green that is not EN1, which would bring the existing habitat-classified total to about 832 hectares.

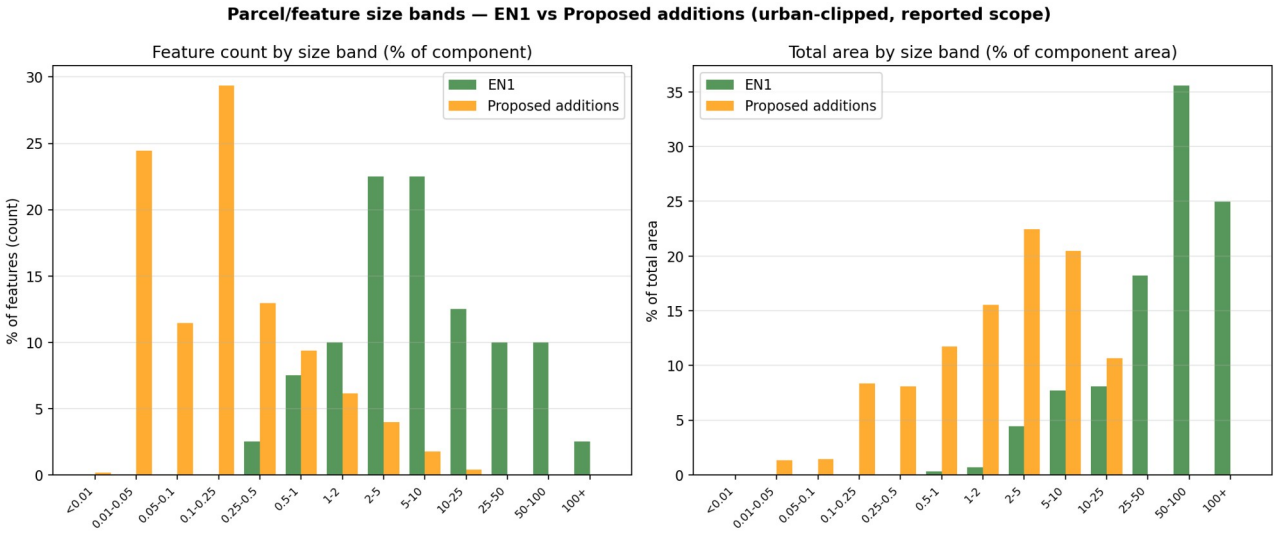


Figure 6. Parcel size composition of the existing EN1 corridors and the proposed additions: count of features by size band (left) and share of area by size band (right). Urban-clipped.

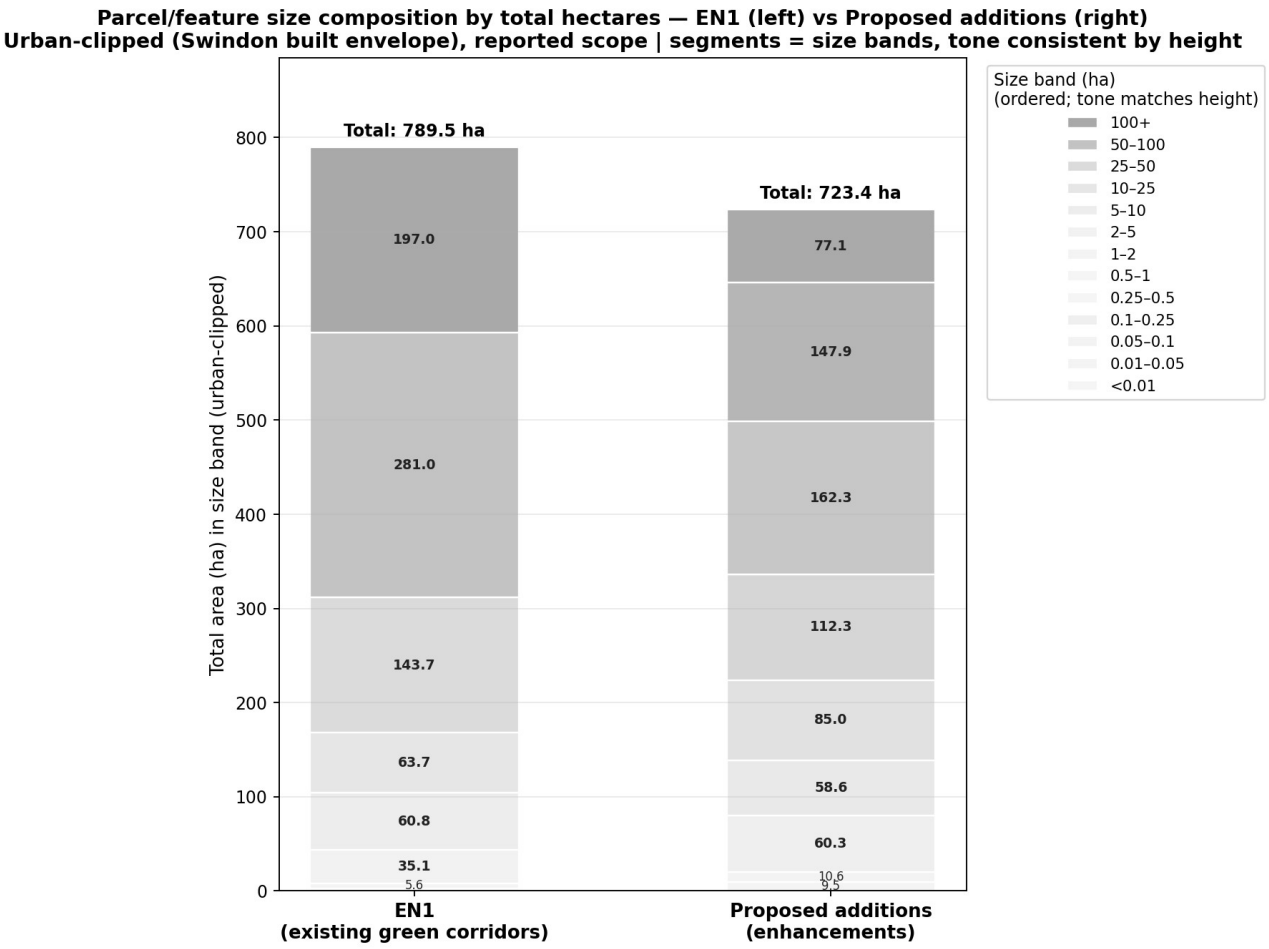


Figure 7. The same comparison in hectares: 789.5 hectares of EN1 ground against 723.4 hectares proposed, segmented by size band.

[3.7] Figures 6 and 7 compare the size of the parcels in each set. The totals are of the same order: 789.5 hectares in the EN1 corridors and 723.4 hectares in the proposed additions. The distribution differs. EN1 holds more of its area in the largest parcels, over 50 hectares, while the additions are spread more evenly across the mid bands, with the bulk of the proposed area in parcels between 2 and 50 hectares.

[3.8] The proposal is therefore not a scatter of insignificant fragments. It is a comparable area of ground, held in parcels of a size the Council has already mapped.

[3.9] All figures show strategic land cover and network relationships. They do not grade habitat quality, show ownership or claim a measured legal boundary. Their purpose is to show the extent, distribution and connections of the green network. Waterways, roads and railway lines provide orientation only. The proposed additions are identified by the proposal symbology and supplied polygon layers.